

PECAN+ (CTF) 2026 Additional Information Sheet

PECAN+ is a long-running, national cyber security [Capture the Flag \(CTF\)](#) competition for Australian high school aged competitors.

Individual registrants should have received a separate email about their allocated team members.

Saturday August 22nd – Competition Training Day

AESTime	ACTIVITY
8:30 am	Arrival and Registration
9:00 am	Introductions and set up
9:30am-10:20am	Training Session 1
10:20am-11:10am	Training Session 2
11:10am-11:40am	Morning Tea
11:40am-12:30pm	Training Session 3
12:30pm-2:00pm	Lunch and Industry Panel
2:00pm-3:15pm	CTF Practice Event
3:15pm-3:30pm	Wrap Up and Key Takeaways

Each student is required to register for the 3 training sessions. Please register through Eventbrite as set out in the accompanying email.

Sunday August 23rd Competition Day and Award Ceremony

The PECAN+ CTF 2026 Competition will run for **4 hrs** on Sunday August 23rd. Teams (2-4 members) are to compete in person. The competition window will be preceded by set up time and will be followed with a livestreamed ceremony announcing national prize winners.

AESTime	ACTIVITY
10.00 am	Arrival and Registration Housekeeping and team set up
11.00 am	Competition opens (4hrs)
3.00 pm	Competition closes. Afternoon Tea
4.00 pm	National Award Ceremony (livestreamed from venue)
5.00 pm	Close

Devices

Competitors must bring their own laptop. Devices are not provided.

National *Prizes and goodies:

- **1st Place Teams:** Flipper Zero w. case + merch (Advanced Division). Raspberry Pi kit + merch (Beginner/Intermediate Divisions).
- **2nd Place Teams:** Duinotech Learning Kit + merch (Advanced/Intermediate Divisions). Arduino Starter Kit + merch (Beginner Division).
- **3rd Place Teams** (in each Division): Lockpick kit + merch.

- **Top All Female Teams** (in each Division): micro:bit V2.2 Go bundle + merch. *Sponsored by [CyberCX](#).*
- **ASD Challenge** (awarded to first Team to complete the 2026 Australian Signals Directorate Challenge): Games pack + merch.
*prize bundles come with one item per Team member.

All competitors will receive a merch bag, PECAN+ 2026 T-shirt, 2026 Challenge Coin and a Participation Certificate.

WiFi on the Day

UNSW will provide free wifi access to competitors, details provided on the day.

Discord

On the day your team will optionally communicate using Discord, we will help you set this up on Saturday.

Permissible use of AI:

Participating teams are expected to solve the challenges by themselves. Very limited use of AI MAY be permissible but put your hand up and get permission first.

For example: a student recognises they can solve something using a short script but doesn't have a full command of a programming language, so chooses to use AI to help them generate an effective script to solve their problem might be acceptable depending on the circumstances. However, under no circumstances would using AI to solve the problem be acceptable.

So, remember if in any doubt put your hand up and ask first.

Ethical behaviour:

PECAN+ is an ethical event. By registering you understand and accept that you will be required to adhere to the Rules and instructions given by staff during your attendance. Furthermore, you acknowledge that you are aware of ethical hacking practices and understand that there are legal ramifications for the misuse of these. You are expected to compete fairly and ethically, including in any use of AI. Failure to adhere to the rules and instructions provided will see you exited from the Competition.

Preparation ahead of the Competition

Students who are new to cyber security do not need to do any preparation ahead of the competition, we will teach you all that you need to know to get underway on the training day.

Experienced students who already have a background in cyber security may optionally wish to check out the following resources ahead of the competition. There are many free cyber upskilling resources available online that can be used to prepare also (see attached training and technical info). Attempt our [PECAN+ Practice Challenges](#) – a walkthrough of some solves is attached.

Kasm Workspaces Virtual Machine

On the weekend an optional toolset will be given to you for the competition if you wish, we will give you training on this on the training day as well.

- Courtesy of our Platform Sponsor, [Kasm Workspaces](#), competitors will be provided with access to a Virtual Machine (VM) for Training and Competition Day. This VM will contain a Kali Linux instance. This will be accessed through a browser.
- If you wish you can use this as a "cyber toolkit" and can be used to help you solve challenges.

- Supported browsers for use of the VM include Chrome 66+, Edge 80+, Firefox 58+, Safari 14+. Please note: Copy/Paste from Kasm Workspaces using ctrl-c/ctrl-v is only supported on Chrome and Edge. In other browsers you will have to copy in/out of a text box.

You are welcome to also use alternative digital tools that you are familiar with to help you solve challenges.

PECAN+ CTF is proudly founded and led by [Edith Cowan University's School of Science](#) and is run in collaboration with Partner organisations around Australia. PECAN+ CTF 2026 is made possible through the support of National Sponsors: [Australian Signals Directorate \(ASD\)](#); [Kasm Workspaces](#); [Australian Information Security Association \(AISA\)](#); [Triskele Labs](#); [Cyberwest Hub](#); [WA Department of Premier and Cabinet, Office of Digital Government](#), [LevelBlue](#) and our numerous regional sponsors and supporters.